

3.1.7 Digital design and manufacture

Computer aided design (CAD)

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Students should be aware of, and be able to describe, the following: - the advantages and disadvantages of using CAD compared to a manually generated alternative - the use of CAD to develop and present ideas for products, including: - the use of 2D CAD for working drawings - the use of 3D CAD to produce presentation drawings - how CAD is used in industrial applications.	Use of datum points and geometry when setting out design drawings. The use of tolerances in dimensioning.

Computer aided manufacture (CAM)

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Students should be aware of, and be able to describe, how CAM is used in the manufacture of products. Specific processes to include: - laser cutting - routing - milling - turning - plotter cutting.	Calculating speeds and times for machining.

Virtual modelling

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Students should be aware of, and be able to describe, how virtual modelling/testing is used in industry prior to product production. Specific processes to include: • simulation • computational fluid dynamics (CFD) as used for testing aerodynamics and wind resistance, and flow of liquids within/ around products • finite element analysis (FEA) as used in component stress analysis.	Interpretation of data from CFD or FEA testing.

Rapid prototyping processes

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Students should be aware of, and be able to describe, rapid prototyping processes, including 3D printing. Students should understand, and be able to explain, the benefits to designers and manufacturers.	Calculating volumes of 3D printed products, calculating time/speed for 3D printing.

Electronic data interchange

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Students should be aware of, and able to describe, the use of electronic point of sales (EPOS) for marketing purposes and the collection of market research data, including: • the maintenance of stock levels • the capture of customer data, eg contact details.	

Production, planning and control (PPC) networking

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Students should be aware of, and able to describe, the role of PCC systems in the planning and control of all aspects of manufacturing, including: • availability of materials • scheduling of machines and people • coordinating suppliers and customers.	